

! SIMULATED PROJECT: FICTIONAL COMPANY, CREATED FOR PORTFOLIO AND LEARNING PURPOSES

Cobbleway Home Services Ltd is not a real business. Names, dates, budgets and results are invented to practise project-management methods from my MSc studies. Nothing here describes a real client or real outcomes.

Project charter and business case

Project Compass: CRM implementation • Cobbleway Home Services Ltd (fictional)

Document	Project charter and outline business case, v1.0 (approved)
Project	Project Compass: CRM implementation
Organisation	Cobbleway Home Services Ltd: a fictional 25-person plumbing, heating and electrical firm in North East England (14 field engineers, 2 apprentices and a 9-person office and management team)
Sponsor / Executive	Helen Marsh, Managing Director (fictional)
Project manager	Chidera Ikenna-Obi (simulated role, MSc practice project)
Approval	Approved at M1 on 11 Mar 2026
Related artefacts	02 Requirements and stakeholder register • 03 WBS and schedule • 04 RAID log • 05 RACI and communications plan • 06 Status dashboard

1. Background and problem

Cobbleway Home Services Ltd handles around 1,100 quotes a year (illustrative) for boiler installs, servicing, repairs and small electrical jobs. Enquiries arrive by phone, email and a website form and are tracked across a shared inbox, two spreadsheets and a whiteboard. There is no single customer record, follow-ups depend on memory, and job details are re-keyed into the accounting package.

- **Lost work:** quotes are not followed up consistently, so winnable jobs go elsewhere.
- **Slow response:** a quote takes about five working days to go out.
- **Missed repeat revenue:** annual boiler-service reminders are sent by hand, when someone remembers.
- **Wasted time:** the office re-keys roughly eight hours of data a week.

2. Objectives

#	Objective (SMART)	Measure
O1	Go live with a cloud CRM for all office staff and 6 lead engineers by 20 May 2026	Go-live milestone M6
O2	Deliver within the approved budget of £36,500 (including £3,500 contingency)	Final cost vs budget
O3	Deliver all Must requirements (REQ-01 to REQ-08)	UAT sign-off
O4	Log 100% of new enquiries in the CRM within 2 weeks of go-live	CRM report vs call log
O5	Cut quote turnaround to 2 working days within 6 months	Benefits review

3. Scope

In scope

- Selection and configuration of a SaaS CRM (enquiries, quotes, pipeline, jobs, service reminders)
- Integration with email and the existing accounting package
- Mobile access for engineers on 6 rugged tablets
- Cleansing and migration of active customer records (last 6 years)

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- Training, quick-reference guides, a champions network and two weeks of hypercare

Out of scope

- Replacing the accounting package (REQ-17)
- Route optimisation for scheduling (REQ-18)
- Website redesign
- Migrating records older than 6 years (archived under the retention rule)

4. Business case

Options appraisal

Option	One-off cost	Benefit	Risk	Decision
1. Do nothing	£0	None; losses continue	Low delivery risk, high business risk	Rejected
2. Improve spreadsheets and shared inbox	~£4,000	Low: still no single record or reminders	Low	Rejected
3. SaaS CRM, configured by a partner	£36,500 incl. contingency	High: meets all Must and most Should needs	Medium (data, adoption)	Recommended
4. Bespoke system	£60,000+	High, but slow to deliver	High (cost, time, support)	Rejected

Costs (option 3)

Category	Budget
CRM licences (18 users, year 1)	£6,800
Supplier configuration and integration	£9,500
Data migration and cleansing	£4,200
Training and materials	£3,000
Internal staff time (backfill)	£6,000
Hardware (6 rugged tablets and cases)	£3,500
Base budget	£33,000
Contingency (about 10%)	£3,500
Total approved budget	£36,500

Expected benefits (illustrative estimates)

Benefit	Baseline	Target	How measured	Owner
Quote turnaround	~5 working days (estimate)	2 working days	CRM report: enquiry to quote sent	Tom Reilly
Quotes followed up	~40% (estimate)	90%	Pipeline follow-up tasks completed	Tom Reilly
Admin re-keying	~8 hours a week	Save 6 hours a week (~£5,000 a year)	Time sample before and after	Priya Shah
Boiler-service bookings from reminders	No automated reminders	+120 bookings a year (~£10,200)	Service jobs created from reminders	Dave Pearson

Benefit	Baseline	Target	How measured	Owner
Quote conversion	~32% (estimate)	+3 percentage points (~£8,000 margin a year)	Won / sent quotes	Helen Marsh

Three-year view

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Costs (project, then licences and support)	£36,500	£7,100	£7,300	£50,900
Benefits (half-year realisation in year 1)	£11,600	£23,200	£23,200	£58,000
Net	-£24,900	+£16,100	+£15,900	+£7,100

Payback is expected during year 3 (around month 30). The case depends most on adoption by engineers and office staff (risk R02), so benefits will be reviewed at 3 and 6 months after go-live.

5. Milestones (baseline)

Milestone	Baseline date	Approver
M1 Charter and business case approved	11 Mar 2026	Helen Marsh
M2 Requirements signed off	24 Mar 2026	Dave Pearson
M3 Supplier selected and contract signed	07 Apr 2026	Helen Marsh
M4 Configuration complete	12 May 2026	Sam Carter
M5 Go/no-go decision	18 May 2026	Helen Marsh
M6 Go-live	20 May 2026	Helen Marsh
M7 Project closed	10 Jun 2026	Helen Marsh

6. Governance and tolerances

Governance follows PRINCE2 principles covered in my MSc module (Managing Projects with PRINCE2): a small project board, management by stages and management by exception against agreed tolerances.

Role	Name	Responsibility
Executive (Sponsor)	Helen Marsh	Owns the business case; approves stages, changes over £500 and go/no-go
Senior User	Dave Pearson	Represents users; signs off requirements and UAT
Senior Supplier	Sam Carter (Northlight CRM Partners, fictional)	Delivers configuration, integration and migration
Project Manager	Chidera Ikenna-Obi (simulated role)	Day-to-day planning, RAID, reporting and change control
Lead CRM Champion	Priya Shah	Data rules, training, champions network

Tolerance	Level	If forecast to be exceeded
Time	±1 week (5 working days) on go-live	Exception report to sponsor
Cost	Up to £3,500 contingency, released by the sponsor	Exception report; re-plan
Scope	Must requirements fixed; Should/Could can be traded	Change request

7. Key risks (see RAID log)

ID	Risk	P × I	Response
R01	Poor legacy data quality delays migration	4×4 = 16	Reduce: data audit in week 3; cleansing rules agreed; supplier-assisted de-duplication
R02	Field engineers do not adopt the mobile app	3×4 = 12	Reduce: Field Supervisor co-designs screens; champions; short hands-on training; usage tracked in hypercare
R03	Accounting integration more complex than quoted	3×4 = 12	Reduce: supplier technical call before contract; contingency held
R06	Customer data migrated without proper retention review	2×5 = 10	Reduce: 6-year retention rule; records older than this archived, not migrated; privacy notice updated
R04	Key staff unavailable for UAT and training	3×3 = 9	Reduce: dates booked at M2; backfill budget; two training sessions per group

8. Assumptions, constraints and dependencies

- 18 named CRM users is enough for year 1 (office team plus 6 tablet users)
- Key users can give one day a week to workshops, UAT and training
- The existing accounting package stays in place
- Office broadband and engineers' 4G are adequate for a cloud CRM
- Constraint: go-live must avoid the October to December heating peak.
- Dependency: accounting package API access (D01) and tablet delivery (D02).

9. Approval

Role	Name	Decision	Date
Sponsor	Helen Marsh	Approved	11 Mar 2026
Senior User	Dave Pearson	Endorsed	11 Mar 2026